YOUSSEF El – Kahky

Junior Penetration Tester | IT Support & Linux Systems

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Portfolio: www.Youssef El-kahky.com

Summary

Entry-level cybersecurity and IT professional with hands-on experience in penetration-testing labs, Linux administration, networking, and web security. Ranked in the top 2% on TryHackMe, with completed Pre Security and Cyber Security 101 paths and ongoing Jr Penetration Tester Certification. Also experienced in technical troubleshooting, web development, client communication, and team leadership. Seeking junior opportunities in cybersecurity, penetration testing, IT support, Linux, or networking.

Technical Skills

- **Offensive Security:** Web application security (XSS, CSRF, SSRF, SQL Injection, Local File Inclusion, WebDAV), Metasploit (scanning, exploitation, post-exploitation), msfvenom payload generation, Linux and Windows privilege escalation, CTF problem solving
- **Password Attacks:** Hydra, John the Ripper, Hashcat, CeWL, CUPP, Crunch
- **IT & Systems:** Linux (Kali as primary OS; package management, APT repository troubleshooting, mount points and storage layout), Windows fundamentals, basic Active Directory concepts, Docker, Git
- **Networking:** TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, subnetting, VLANs, common ports and protocols, packet analysis with Wireshark
- **Development:** Go, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Bootstrap, jQuery, PHP, MySQL (basics), SEO and website performance optimization
- **Practices:** Vulnerability assessment, OSINT, technical reporting and documentation, troubleshooting and root-cause diagnosis
- **Business & Marketing:** Marketing strategy, market and competitor research, content strategy, social media management, Meta Ads management, campaign performance tracking, funnel building, brand positioning
- **Professional:** Client communication, leadership and team management, project management, analytical thinking, problem solving

Certifications & Training

- **TryHackMe Jr Penetration Tester Path (PT1):** In progress, certification exam planned for October 2026
- **RedHat System Administration I:** Information Technology Institute (ITI) - Completed — October 2026
  - Training through ITI, covering practical Linux system administration fundamentals.
- **TryHackMe Cyber Security 101 and Pre Security paths:**
  - completed (networking, Linux, and Windows fundamentals included); **top 2% global ranking** with multiple badges
- **CompTIA Security+ and Network+:** self-study completed (exams not yet taken)

Education

- **Diploma in Software Engineering & Advanced Tech Solutions | 01-Talent (France)** 2025 - 2027 (Expected)
  - **Immersive, project-based software engineering curriculum focusing on full-stack development, algorithmic logic, data structures, and secure coding practices.**
- **Bachelor of Marketing, Faculty of Tourism & Hotels, El-Mansoura University (GPA 3.7 / 4.0)** Graduated 2025
- **Military Service:** Completed (2025)
- **Languages:** English (fluent, spoken and written)

Experience

- **Ethical Hacking Instructor – Student Club** (Zagazig University - 2024)
  - Designed and delivered hands-on penetration testing and cybersecurity workshops for computer science and engineering students.
  - Provided practical training in ethical hacking tools and methodologies.

- **Marketing Manager — OTB (Out Of the Box Marketing Agency)** (2024 – 2026)
  2 year of full-time corporate experience
  - Primary liaison for 20+ clients: gathered requirements, briefed internal teams, and delivered timely performance reports
  - Conducted market research, competitive analysis, and audience segmentation, identifying 10+ growth opportunities.
  - Developed marketing strategies (positioning, messaging, funnels, KPIs) and monthly content calendars, increasing client platform engagement by 50%.
  - Led and mentored a team of content creators, media buyers, and graphic designers; oversaw ads management and performance optimization with quality assurance and on-time delivery.

- **Freelance Web Developer & Digital Marketer** (2021 - Present)
  - Built websites and optimized landing pages using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Bootstrap, and jQuery for clients across 8+ industries.
  - Designed and executed marketing strategies and content plans focused on measurable business growth.
  - Performed technical website audits, SEO analyses, and performance optimization, increasing organic traffic by 25% on average for key clients

- **Intern — Cairo Airport Company (CAC)** (40 Days, 2023)
  - Gained practical exposure to corporate marketing functions, Public Relations (PR), and strategies for enhancing customer experience and branding

- **Vice President of Marketing – Enactus Zagazig** (2024)
  - Directed the marketing department, successfully managing content creation, awareness campaigns, and overall social media strategy.
  - Built and delivered a structured educational curriculum (training, tasks, workshops) for 30+ new members, fostering skill development within the team.
  - Supervised a team of creators, designers, and coordinators, achieving all departmental marketing and outreach goals

Projects & LaBs

- **TryHackMe Labs & CTFs:** Regularly solve CTF rooms and challenges in preparation for PT1, covering web vulnerabilities, password cracking, Metasploit, and privilege escalation. Maintain structured technical notes and publish educational and CTF event write-ups on Medium.
- **JAVE, Local AI Assistant (Go, Docker, Ollama):** Built a CLI assistant running a local LLM (Ollama) with conversation history, project-tree scanning, workspace context injection, Docker-based sandboxed execution, a WebSocket bridge to VS Code, and pre-flight health checks; developed and run on Kali Linux.
- **ascii-art and go-reloaded (Go):** Built a CLI that renders text as ASCII art from banner files, and a text-transformation pipeline (capitalization, case and base conversion, punctuation spacing, quote normalization, article correction), refactored for idiomatic Go, input validation, and explicit error handling.
- **ascii-art-web (Go):** Extended the ascii-art CLI into an HTTP web server using net/http and html/template, with form input handling and HTTP status codes.
- **Linux Workstation & Troubleshooting:** Maintain a Kali Linux workstation with a multi-partition storage layout for workspace, AI, and container data. Resolved APT mirror routing failures during a system upgrade (retry configuration, alternate CDN mirror) and diagnosed display overscan issues.
- **Personal Portfolio Website (HTML, CSS, JavaScript):** Designed and built a portfolio showcasing marketing, development, and cybersecurity work, with a terminal-style hero section and animated skill meters.